

CHROMATIC ii-V's

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #130

Thelonious Monk, John Coltrane, Bennie Golson . . . the history of bebop and post bop is filled with chromatic ii-V progressions. These composers just took that wonderful ii - V progression you know and love, moved it up or down by a half step, and there you have it. Chromatic ii-V's. Learning to play these tricky progressions takes us to a new level.

At www.JazzWire.net, we address this progression in three different ways, at three different developmental/ability levels, in an ongoing discussion for weeks and months at a time.

Approach #1 - Transposition. Move a melodic idea in parallel with the changes.

Approach #2 - Call & Response. Our second idea is responding to the first idea.

Approach #3 - Contrary Motion. Move the melody in the opposite direction of the harmony.

Here, we use the first two measures of Thelonious Monk's "Ask Me Now" as our laboratory.

#1 - Transposing a simple idea



#2 - A "Call" with a differing "Response"



#3 - Contrary Motion

